

Gautam Velpula

Senior Director, Technology & Engineering

Product Operating Model • Platform Architecture • Engineering Excellence

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Executive Summary

Technology leader with 12+ years of experience driving engineering strategy, delivery excellence, and platform architecture across cross-functional product teams. Proven ability to own technical vision and architecture guardrails while enabling team-level autonomy and rapid delivery. Deep experience translating product and business strategy into cohesive technical direction, coaching senior technical leaders, and using data to continuously improve engineering throughput and reliability. Combines strong technical taste with outcome-oriented leadership to accelerate customer and business results.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

- Owned the technical vision and architecture guardrails across a portfolio of cross-functional product teams spanning digital platforms, payments, marketing technology, and data—serving as the single architectural authority for the enterprise.
- Partnered closely with Product and Design leadership to co-own outcomes, translating product strategy into cohesive technical direction and ensuring engineering teams contributed to discovery, feasibility assessment, and rapid experimentation.
- Drove architectural consistency across 7 brand product teams while enabling team-level autonomy—balancing near-term delivery velocity with long-term platform sustainability and scalability.
- Established and enforced engineering standards across CI/CD, testing, observability, and security, reducing time-to-market by approximately 40% and improving system uptime by approximately 30%.
- Used data to continuously improve delivery performance, tracking cycle time, reliability, defects, and availability to identify and remove systemic impediments to flow.
- Made explicit trade-offs across speed, cost, risk, and scalability—communicating technical constraints, dependencies, and risks early to enable informed business decisions.
- Led the design of a unified digital platform consolidating 7 independent brand applications into a composable, shared architecture—reducing the marginal cost of delivery across the portfolio.
- Re-architected backend systems to a microservices and event-driven model, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns to improve scalability and team independence.
- Designed and delivered payments integration with FreedomPay and a subscription service supporting new business models, including hands-on technical intervention during a critical system failure.
- Championed enterprise-wide AI and LLM adoption: defined architectural patterns, guardrails, and governance for safe, scalable usage across product and engineering teams.
- Directly managed and developed a cohort of principal and lead architects, setting clear expectations for technical leadership, decision-making, and cross-functional collaboration.
- Coached senior technical leaders to operate as strong partners to Product Managers and business stakeholders, building bench strength through mentoring and targeted growth plans.
- Served as primary technology partner to business leadership, communicating progress, trade-offs, and investment decisions in clear, outcome-focused language.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Led multi-million-dollar digital transformation and cloud modernization engagements for Fortune 500 clients, directing cross-functional teams spanning engineering, architecture, product, and design.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise assessment of a legacy platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture and modernization roadmap.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading technology provider, ensuring continuity and platform health throughout the transition.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable engineering roadmaps and framing trade-offs in outcome-focused language.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Achieved approximately 95% client satisfaction and repeat business by consistently delivering measurable customer and business outcomes.
- Mentored delivery leaders and principals, strengthening leadership depth and building bench strength across the practice.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations for Fortune 500 clients with end-to-end accountability from pre-sales through go-live.
- Directly managed and coached senior engineers and delivery leads, scaling the team through recruiting, mentoring, and succession planning.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, translating business objectives into technical delivery plans and surfacing risks early to enable informed decisions.
- Served as the senior-most technical leader within services, providing system design guidance, escalation support, and architecture direction.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through standardized delivery practices and a culture of continuous improvement.
- Partnered with product management to influence roadmap based on client needs and delivery insights.

Technology & Platform Expertise

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions), Google Cloud Platform, Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture: Microservices, event-driven systems, composable architecture, API-first design, cloud-native patterns

Engineering Practices: CI/CD, DevOps, observability (Splunk, GA4, Firebase), secure-by-design, SRE principles

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB, Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

AI/ML: LLM integration patterns, agentic AI architectures, AI governance frameworks

Core Strengths

Product Operating Model Leadership • Technical Strategy & Architecture • Engineering Execution & Delivery Performance • Tech Lead Coaching & Development • Cross-Functional Collaboration (Product, Design, Business) • Executive Communication • AI/LLM Strategy • Platform Scalability

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India